

Four flats. R1,700 a month between the cheapest and the dearest.

Petra Nera is still the cheapest, but only just — the R8,800 SoHo unit is **R230 behind it**. Meander in Midrand is the most expensive to run and the cheapest to move into: **zero deposit, month-to-month, internet included**. Cost has stopped deciding this.

PETRA NERA	SOHO @ R8,800	SOHO @ R9,500	MEANDER, MIDRAND
R13,593	R13,823	R14,523	R15,278
3 bed · cheapest to run	2 bed · R230 behind, R115 each	Same complex, R700 more rent	2 bed · dearest monthly, cheapest move-in

ONE CHANGE TO THE MODEL THIS ROUND

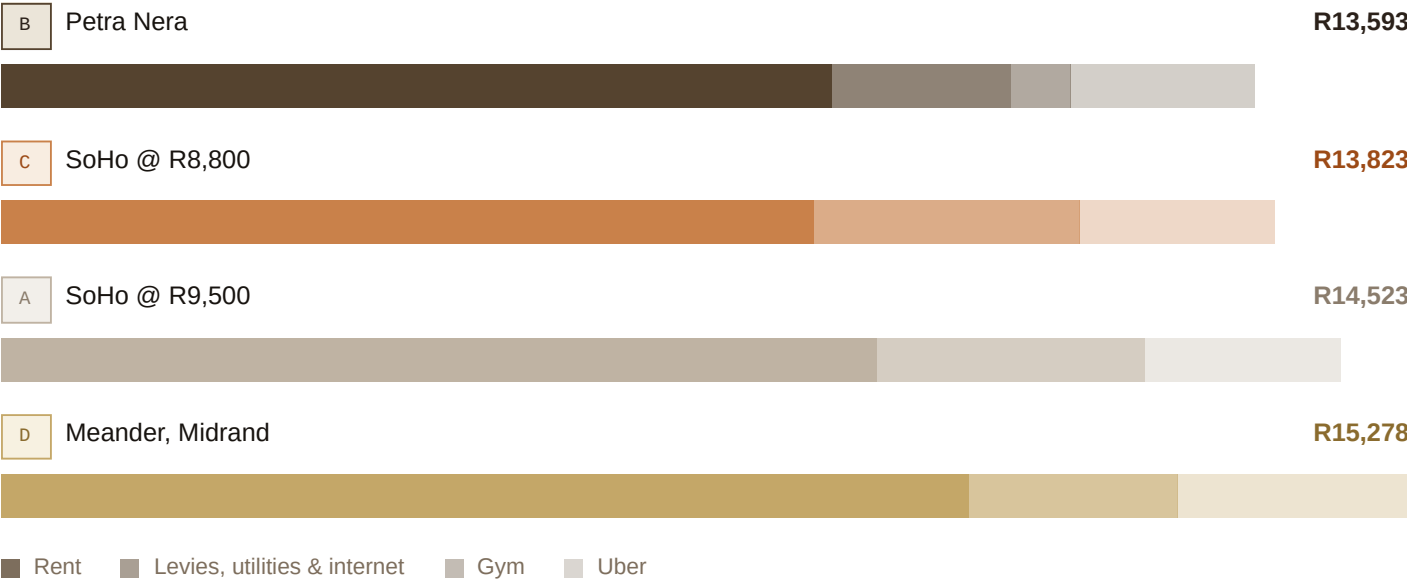
Meander includes **free uncapped internet**, which exposed a gap: internet was not costed for any option before. It is now a line item at **R800 a month** for the three flats that do not include it, and R0 for Meander. Every total on this page is therefore about R800 higher than the previous version. The *gaps between* Petra Nera and the two SoHo units are unchanged — the same R800 was added to each.

THE SHORTLIST

Four options

OPTION B Petra Nera 14 Riverbend Rd, Hoogland, Randburg 3 bed · 2 bath Six-minute walk to CRC R13,593 TRUE MONTHLY Rent R9,000 · deposit R9,000 · admin R2,000. Plain, no amenities — but the extra bedroom and no church commute.	OPTION C SoHo Junction — R8,800 Broadacres, Sandton 2 bed · 2 bath · balcony Available 1 August 2026 R13,823 TRUE MONTHLY Deposit R9,000 · 1 carport · no pets. Gym, pool, clubhouse, 24- hour manned security.	OPTION A SoHo Junction — R9,500 4 Poplar Ave, Broadacres Park 2 bed · 2 bath · 62 m² Available 1 October 2026 R14,523 TRUE MONTHLY Deposit R10,000 · 2 bays · cats allowed. Same building as C, R700 more rent.	OPTION D — NEW Meander Lifestyle 1 Celery Drive, Treesbank AH, Midrand 2 bed · 2 bath · 68 m² 3rd floor+, Helderfontein R15,278 TRUE MONTHLY Zero deposit · month- to-month · 2 bays. Levies R1,365. Gym, padel, pools, restaurant, solar & water backup, free uncapped internet.
--	---	---	---

WHERE THE MONEY GOES



Bars are drawn to the same scale. Meander's extra cost is roughly half rent and half Uber — Midrand is further from both CRC and Wits than anything else on this list.

THE CORE NUMBER

What each costs every month

FULL MONTHLY COST – TWO PEOPLE, UBER FOR ALL TRAVEL				
LINE ITEM	B – PETRA NERA	C – SOHO 8,800	A – SOHO 9,500	D – MEANDER
Rent	R9,000	R8,800	R9,500	R10,500
Levies D: stated on listing, security included	—	—	—	R1,365
Sanitation SoHo: confirmed on the R9,500 listing	unknown	R900	R900	in levies?
Refuse & security SoHo: confirmed on the R9,500 listing	unknown	R500	R500	in levies
Electricity B: your figure · others: estimate	R1,000	R650	R650	R800
Water	R150	R50	R50	R100
Internet uncapped fibre	R800	R800	R800	R0 — included
Housing subtotal	R10,950	R11,700	R12,400	R12,765
Gym membership	R650	R0 — on site	R0 — on site	R0 — on site
Uber — CRC 13 round trips a month	R0 — walk	R1,300	R1,300	R1,560
Uber — Wits 4.3 round trips a month	R823	R823	R823	R953
Uber — gym 13 round trips a month	R1,170	R0	R0	R0
Transport subtotal	R1,993	R2,123	R2,123	R2,513
Monthly total	R13,593	R13,823	R14,523	R15,278
Per person	R6,797	R6,912	R7,287	R7,639
Gap to Petra Nera	—	R230 R115 each	R980 R490 each	R1,685 R843 each

THE NEW OPTION

Meander is a different kind of offer

It is the most expensive to run and by far the cheapest to move into. It is also the only one of the four with no twelve-month commitment.

WHAT IT DOES BETTER THAN EVERYTHING ELSE

Zero deposit. Every other option wants R9,000–R10,000 held for a year.

Month-to-month lease. No twelve-month lock-in, no cancellation penalty. If Wits, work or anything else might move you within the year, this is worth real money.

Free uncapped internet. R800 a month and no installation.

Solar backup and water backup. The only option with confirmed load-shedding and water-outage protection — both are live problems in Johannesburg.

68 m² and two bays. The largest two-bed here, and the levies are stated rather than inferred.

WHAT IT COSTS YOU

R1,685 a month more than Petra Nera, R1,405 more than the R8,800 SoHo — roughly R17,000–R20,000 a year. Two things drive it: rent is R1,700 above SoHo, and Midrand is further from everywhere you go. CRC costs about **R1,560 a month in fares against SoHo’s R1,300 and Petra Nera’s nothing**, and Wits is dearer too. The amenities are excellent, but you already get a free gym at either SoHo unit.

MEANDER — WHAT THE LISTING STATES AND WHAT IT DOES NOT		
ITEM	FIGURE	STATUS
Rent	R10,500	Stated
Levies — security included	R1,365	Stated. Special levy R0
Deposit	R0	“Zero deposit apartments available” — confirm it applies to <i>this</i> unit, and whether a deposit-replacement fee or insurance product substitutes for it
Lease	Month-to-month	Stated. Confirm notice period and how often rent can be revised
Internet	Included, uncapped	Stated
Floor size	68 m²	Stated — the largest two-bed of the four
Parking	2 secure carport	Stated, plus visitor parking
Electricity	~R800 est.	Not stated. Estimated with gas hobs and solar offset. Ask for a current tenant’s figure and whether the geyser is electric, gas or solar
Water	~R100 est.	Not stated. First 6 kL free on Joburg Water
Sanitation & refuse	unclear	Ask. Likely inside the R1,365, but if billed on top the gap widens by up to R1,400
Availability	1 July 2026	Available now
Pets	None	Despite the dog park

THE NUMBER TO CHECK FIRST

The Uber fares to CRC and Wits are my estimates, not yours. They are extrapolated from the two fares you gave — R50 over about 5 km and R95 over about 25 km — which fits roughly R39 plus R2.25 a kilometre. Meander sits about 10 km from CRC and 32 km from Wits, giving R60 and R110 a trip. That is **R2,513 a month, and it is the single biggest reason Meander is dearest.** Price both trips in the app before taking this seriously either way.

SAME BUILDING, DIFFERENT FLAT

The two SoHo units

SOHO JUNCTION — R8,800 AGAINST R9,500			
	C — R8,800	A — R9,500	WHAT IT MEANS
Rent	R8,800	R9,500	R700 a month — R8,400 a year
Deposit	R9,000	R10,000	R1,000 less cash up front
Parking	1 undercover carport	2 bays	The clearest loss — worth R250–R500 a month if either of you gets a car
Floor size	not stated	62 m ²	Confirm this. If C is materially smaller, the saving is not free
Available	1 August 2026	1 October 2026	C is available now — no gap, no overlap month, no storage
Pets	None	Cats only	Only matters if a cat was in the plan
Facilities	Shared — pool, clubhouse, gym, sauna, steam room, business centre , jungle gym, 24-hour manned security, concierge, lifts		Now confirmed. The developer lists the Activity Centre — gym, sauna, steam room and business centre — as a complex facility, so it comes with either unit. This was an open question in the previous version
Fittings	Gas hobs · central water heating · low-energy lights · inverter-ready		Developer specification, complex-wide. This is why the electricity estimate is R650 rather than R900–R1,000
All-in monthly	R13,823	R14,523	C dominates A on cost. A is only worth it for the second bay and the confirmed 62 m²

ONE ASSUMPTION DOING A LOT OF WORK

The R8,800 listing **does not state the levies**. The R900 sanitation and R500 refuse/security are carried across from the R9,500 listing for the same complex — these are body-corporate charges, so they should be identical, but that is an inference rather than a quoted figure. **Confirm both before signing.**

TRANSPORT — UBER

Location is most of the difference

Three days a week to CRC — Monday, Tuesday, Thursday. Wednesday to Wits, with no CRC on campus days. Both SoHo units share fares; Meander is further from both.

FARES AND MONTHLY UBER SPEND				
TRIP	ROUND TRIPS	B — PETRA NERA	SOHO, EITHER UNIT	D — MEANDER
Home → CRC fare each way	13	R0 — walk	R1,300 R50 — your figure	R1,560 ~R60 — estimated
Home → Wits Braamfontein	4.3	R823 ~R95 — your figure	R823 ~R95 — your figure	R953 ~R110 — estimated
Home → Planet Fitness Fourways	13	R1,170 ~R45 — estimated	R0 gym on site	R0 gym on site
Monthly Uber spend		R1,993	R2,123	R2,513

THE COUNTER-INTUITIVE RESULT

Walking to CRC saves **R1,300 a month** against SoHo — the single biggest line difference here. But Ubering to the gym costs **R1,170** of it straight back. Net transport difference: **R130 a month**. Petra Nera's location advantage is almost entirely spent reaching a gym that the other three give you for free.

GYM FREQUENCY DECIDES B AGAINST C

VISITS A WEEK	B TOTAL	VS C (R13,823)
2×	R13,203	B ahead R620
3×	R13,593	B ahead R230
3.6×	~R13,823	Dead even
4×	R13,983	C ahead R160
5×	R14,373	C ahead R550
6×	R14,763	C ahead R940

The crossover was 6.4 visits a week against the R9,500 unit, 5.5 after the utility correction, and **3.7** now — barely more than three times a week.

DISTANCES — CONTEXT ONLY

Petra Nera → CRC	~500 m — 6 min walk
SoHo → CRC	~5 km
Meander → CRC	~10 km
Petra Nera → Wits	~24 km
SoHo → Wits	~25 km
Meander → Wits	~32 km
Petra Nera → gym	~3.5 km

Fares drive the model, not kilometres — these are shown to sense-check the fares. Local travel time is roughly 6.5 hrs a month at SoHo, 7.3 at Petra Nera and about 9 at Meander.

CASH

Moving in, and the first year

CASH NEEDED TO MOVE IN				
ITEM	B — PETRA NERA	C — SOHO 8,800	A — SOHO 9,500	D — MEANDER
Deposit refundable	R9,000	R9,000	R10,000	R0
First month's rent	R9,000	R8,800	R9,500	R10,500
Admin / lease initiation	R2,000 above market	~R1,250	~R1,250	~R1,250
Credit check	included?	~R300	~R300	~R300
Meter activation, tags	~R500	~R500	~R500	~R500
Gym joining fee	~R350	R0	R0	R0
Fibre install + router	R0 – R1,800	R0 – R1,800	R0 – R1,800	R0
Moving costs	R3,000 – 6,000	R3,000 – 6,000	R3,000 – 6,000	R3,000 – 6,000
Cash needed	R23,850 – 28,650	R22,850 – 27,650	R24,550 – 29,350	R15,550 – 18,550

THE ONE PLACE MEANDER WINS OUTRIGHT

R7,300 to R9,000 less cash to move in than any other option — a zero deposit and no fibre installation. If the constraint right now is what you can put on the table this month rather than what you pay each month, that is a serious advantage. It is cash flow rather than cost, though: the deposit elsewhere comes back at the end.

YEAR-ONE TOTAL				
	B — PETRA NERA	C — SOHO 8,800	A — SOHO 9,500	D — MEANDER
Twelve months of running cost	R163,116	R165,876	R174,276	R183,336
Non-refundable once-offs	~R7,750	~R7,450	~R7,450	~R6,550
Year-one cash out	~R170,900	~R173,300	~R181,700	~R189,900
Plus deposit held	R9,000	R9,000	R10,000	R0
Difference vs Petra Nera	—	R2,400 R1,200 each	R10,800	R19,000 R9,500 each

WIDER SEARCH

Other 2-bed, 2-bath options

Four more complexes in the same band, all with two bathrooms. Rents are quoted from live listings; **levies and utilities are modelled**, so treat the totals as a ranking to investigate rather than a result. **None of them beats the R8,800 SoHo unit.**

THE FILTER THAT CAME OUT OF THIS ANALYSIS

Only look at complexes with a gym on site. Without one you pay R650 for Planet Fitness plus roughly R1,170 in Uber fares — **R1,820 a month** before you have compared a single rand of rent. That is more than the entire spread between the four options above. A R9,000 flat with no gym costs more to live in than a R10,500 flat with one.

OTHER COMPLEXES FOUND — MODELLED AGAINST THE SAME ASSUMPTIONS					
COMPLEX	RENT	GYM ON SITE	LOCATION	MODELLED ALL-IN	VS SOHO R8,800
Kalgaro Lifestyle Estate Swallow Drive, Douglasdale — live listing confirmed	R10,500 not R8,999	Yes	Douglasdale closest to CRC after Petra Nera	~R15,500	+R1,670
Helderfontein Nexus 20 Broadacres Drive, Dainfern	R10,500 68 m²	Yes	Dainfern Meander's sister development	~R15,100	+R1,240
The Kanyin 109 Leeuwkop Road, Sunninghill	R11,000 up to R12,500	Yes	Sunninghill further from CRC	~R16,400	+R2,560
Olea View 30 Cedar Avenue West, Fourways	R11,000 77 m² — largest here	No	Fourways same fares as SoHo	~R18,000	+R4,220

NOW CONFIRMED — AND IT DOES NOT WIN

Kalgaro Lifestyle Estate

Swallow Drive, Douglasdale · 2 bed / 2 bath · first floor · available 1 September 2026

The live listing is **R10,500, not the R8,999 that appeared on two now-delisted adverts**. That R1,500 is the whole story: it takes Kalgaro from marginally ahead of the R8,800 SoHo unit to about **R1,670 a month behind it**.

The listing also confirms that “**electricity, water, domestic effluent, refuse and intercom**” are **billed on top of the rent** — the same hidden-charge structure as SoHo, and worth roughly R1,200 a month. Nothing here is included.

What it does well: a **double covered carport** — better than the R8,800 SoHo unit's single bay — plus an indoor gym, pool and 24-hour security, and Douglasdale puts it closer to CRC than either SoHo flat, saving about R130 a month in fares. Modern open-plan kitchen with stone counters, covered balcony, en-suite plus family bathroom. No pets.

Worth watching: if a unit comes up at the R8,999 the delisted adverts showed, it models at about R14,000 — level with the R8,800 SoHo flat rather than better than it. At R10,500 it is not competitive.

MEANDER'S SISTER

Helderfontein Nexus

20 Broadacres Drive, Dainfern — off Winnie Mandela Drive

Same operator, same product, same price as Meander: 68 m² two-bed from **R10,500**, levies about R1,365, free uncapped internet, solar and water backup, gas hobs, biometric access, and free use of the gym, pool, padel court, clubhouse and sports field.

Why it may beat Meander: Broadacres Drive is nearer the Fourways side than Celery Drive, which should trim the CRC fare. If you like the Houss product, **compare these two on distance to CRC alone** — everything else about them is effectively identical. Note one source quotes levies at R1,514, another at R1,365; confirm which applies.

THE KANYIN — GOOD, BUT PRICED OUT

Genuinely strong facilities — gym, two pools, squash court, creche, clubhouse, landscaped gardens, 24-hour biometric security — and proper two-bed two-bath units. But 2-bed stock sits at **R11,000–R12,500**, and Sunninghill is further from CRC than Fourways. It lands about R2,500 a month above the R8,800 SoHo unit. Worth a look only if you fall for the estate.

OLEA VIEW — THE CAUTIONARY EXAMPLE

On paper it looks good: **77 m²**, the largest unit in this whole comparison, two full bathrooms, pool, braai, fibre, covered carport, available 1 August, deposit R13,000. But **there is no gym** — so it carries the full R1,820 fitness penalty on top of R11,000 rent. It models out around **R18,000 a month**, roughly R4,100 above the R8,800 SoHo unit. A good flat that the maths rules out.

WHAT THIS SEARCH DID AND DID NOT COVER

Searched: Fourways, Broadacres, Douglasdale, Dainfern, Sunninghill and Helderfontein, for two-bed two-bath stock between roughly R8,000 and R11,500. **Not exhaustive** — Property24 alone lists several hundred rentals across these suburbs and most listings do not state bathrooms, levies or amenities, so filtering reliably from the outside is not possible. Lonehill, Craigavon, Witkoppen and Bryanston were not covered in depth. Levies and utilities are unconfirmed for all four options in this section, which is why they are shown as a ranking rather than added to the main comparison.

STRESS TEST

What would flip this

Petra Nera leads the R8,800 SoHo unit by R230 a month. At that margin almost anything flips it — and it flips in one direction far more easily than the other.

SENSITIVITY — PETRA NERA AGAINST SOHO R8,800, EACH SCENARIO ON ITS OWN

IF...	B MONTHLY	GAP	VERDICT
You go to gym twice a week rather than three times	R13,203	R620	Petra Nera ahead
Base case — utilities R1,150, gym 3× a week	R13,593	R230	Petra Nera marginally ahead
SoHo's electricity is R900 rather than R650	R13,593	R480	Petra Nera ahead
You go to gym 3.6 times a week	~R13,823	~R0	Dead even
You go to gym four times a week	R13,983	–R160	SoHo cheaper
The gym Uber fare is R60 each way, not R45	R13,983	–R160	SoHo cheaper
Petra Nera bills sanitation and refuse on top, at R700	R14,293	–R470	SoHo cheaper
Petra Nera bills them at SoHo's level, R1,400	R14,993	–R1,170	SoHo much cheaper

READ THIS ROW BY ROW

Five of eight scenarios make SoHo the cheaper flat, and the two that favour Petra Nera most require you to use the gym *less*. **Petra Nera's cost advantage has essentially disappeared.** The case for it now rests on the third bedroom and the walk to church — both real, neither financial.

PROS AND CONS

The three live options

The R9,500 SoHo unit is left out here — it is the same building as the R8,800 unit for R700 more a month. It only comes back into play if you need the second parking bay or the confirmed 62 m².

OPTION C SoHo Junction — R8,800 2 bed / 2 bath, Broadacres · R13,823 all-in IN FAVOUR — Within R230 a month of the cheapest option — R115 each. Cost no longer separates it from Petra Nera — The gym costs nothing to reach. At Petra Nera staying fit runs R1,820 a month once Uber is counted — Pool, clubhouse and jungle gym on the same terms — zero travel, zero friction — 24-hour manned security with a guard house — Central geyser with electricity included — R300 a month below Petra Nera's bill — Available 1 August — no gap, no overlap month, no storage — Closer to CRC than Meander, at R1,300 a month against R1,560 — R700 a month cheaper than the other unit in the same building, for the same facilities — Private balcony, open-plan living, gas/electric stove	OPTION B Petra Nera — R9,000 3 bed / 2 bath, Riverbend Rd · R13,593 all-in IN FAVOUR — Walking distance to CRC — R1,300 a month saved, and nothing between you and being there — A third bedroom for two people — a permanent study, always available — Still the cheapest of the four, by R230 a month — More space for the money than either SoHo unit — No transport decision before church — midweek involvement carries no fare — Utilities confirmed at R1,150, and they corroborate SoHo's estimate — Least exposed if Uber fares rise
---	--

AGAINST

- **One bedroom fewer than Petra Nera** — the difference between having a study and not
- **Only one parking bay, and floor size not stated**
- The levies are inferred from the sister listing, not quoted
- R1,400 a month of fixed levies outside the advertised rent
- R1,300 a month in Uber fares to CRC
- No pets · pre-paid water and electricity with no grace period
- No confirmed load-shedding or water backup, unlike Meander
- Available now also means it will go quickly

AGAINST

- **The cost advantage is now R230 a month** — R115 each. It was R1,672 when this comparison started
- **Not attractive** — and this is where you both live and host every day
- **Staying fit costs R1,820 a month** — membership plus Uber, plus ~4.3 hours of travel
- **Sanitation and refuse still unaccounted for.** Anything above R230 and SoHo wins outright
- **R2,000 admin fee** — roughly double market rate, non-refundable
- Pays for its own geyser: R1,000 electricity against SoHo's R650
- No pool, clubhouse, gym or backup power
- Security arrangements unknown — must be seen
- Walking to CRC after dark needs an honest safety assessment first

OPTION D

Meander Lifestyle — R10,500

2 bed / 2 bath / 68 m², Midrand · R15,278 all-in

IN FAVOUR

- **Zero deposit** — R7,300–R9,000 less cash to move in than anything else here
- **Month-to-month lease.** The only option with no twelve-month lock-in and no cancellation penalty — genuinely valuable if anything might change within the year
- **Free uncapped internet** — R800 a month, no installation
- **Solar backup and water backup.** The only option with confirmed load-shedding and outage protection
- **68 m²** — the largest two-bed of the four, with two secure bays
- Levies stated at R1,365 rather than inferred, with security included and no special levy
- By far the biggest amenity offer — gym with classes, padel, pools, sports field, clubhouse, restaurant, coffee shop, meeting rooms
- Gas hobs, en-suite bathrooms, walk-in closet, available now

AGAINST

- **The most expensive to run — R1,685 a month above Petra Nera, R1,405 above the R8,800 SoHo.** About R19,000 more over year one
- **Furthest from everywhere you go.** R1,560 a month to CRC and R953 to Wits — roughly R2,513 in fares against SoHo's R2,123
- **Those fares are my estimate, not yours —** and they are the main reason it lands last. Check both in the app
- Rent is R1,700 above the R8,800 SoHo unit for the same number of bedrooms
- Electricity and water not stated — both are estimates
- Month-to-month cuts both ways: the landlord can also end it, and rent may be revised more often
- “Zero deposit *available*” — confirm it applies to this unit and that no fee or insurance product replaces it
- Still only two bedrooms, so no study — the same limitation as SoHo, at a higher price
- No pets · furthest from CRC of all four, and the longest travel time at ~9 hrs a month

VERDICT

Petra Nera and the R8,800 SoHo unit are R230 a month apart — R115 each. That is no longer a financial decision. Meander costs about R19,000 more over a year, and buys flexibility rather than value.

The gap has closed steadily: R1,672 when this started, R1,330 once Uber replaced the car, R980 when Petra Nera's real utility bill arrived, and R230 now that the cheaper SoHo unit is on the table. It is fragile in one direction only — five of eight stress-test scenarios make SoHo cheaper, while the ones favouring Petra Nera need you to use the gym less.

So the live choice is a straight trade, and both sides are real: **a third bedroom and a six-minute walk to church**, against **a gym, a pool, a guard house and a flat you would rather come home to**. Meander only wins if what you need is a short lease and low move-in cash.

FOUR QUESTIONS DECIDE IT

- Q1 **How big is the R8,800 SoHo unit?** The R9,500 flat is 62 m²; this one does not say. If it is materially smaller the R700 is not a saving, and Petra Nera's three bedrooms pull ahead. Quick to ask, and it could end the comparison.
- Q2 **Does Petra Nera bill sanitation and refuse on top of the R1,150?** SoHo charges R1,400 for exactly these. Anything above R230 and SoHo is cheaper outright — a low bar to clear.
- Q3 **Will you train more than three times a week?** At 3.6 visits the two are level; past that SoHo is cheaper *and* has the gym downstairs.
- Q4 **Do you need to be able to leave?** If there is a real chance you move within twelve months, Meander's month-to-month lease and zero deposit are worth more than the R1,405 a month it costs over SoHo. If you are settling for a year or more, they are not.

Recommendation: the **R8,800 SoHo unit**, unless the floor size comes back materially below 62 m² or the third bedroom genuinely matters more than the amenities. It is R700 a month below the unit you first looked at, available now, cheapest of the Fourways options to move into, and it costs R115 each a month more than Petra Nera for a gym, a pool and a manned guard house. **Move quickly — it was available from 1 August.**

Choose **Petra Nera** if the third room is genuinely load-bearing, or if walking to church matters more than any of this. Choose **Meander** if you cannot or do not want to commit to twelve months, or if move-in cash is the binding constraint — but price the two Uber trips first, because they are what put it last.

BEFORE SIGNING

Questions to ask

SOHO JUNCTION — R8,800

1. **What is the floor size?** The other unit in this complex is 62 m².
2. **Confirm the levies** — is sanitation R900 and refuse/security R500, as on the sister listing?
3. Do the levies escalate annually, and by how much?
4. **Confirm water is included in the levy**, as the sale listings state — and that the R900 sanitation charge covers sewerage rather than sitting on top of a separate water bill.
5. **Ask a current tenant, or the estate manager, what a two-bed actually spends on prepaid electricity.** With gas hobs and central water heating it should be R500–R1,000. This is the last unverified number of any size.
6. Is the carport allocated, and can a second bay be rented? At what cost?
7. What is the annual escalation percentage?
8. Any special levies planned? Can we see the last two AGM minutes and the reserve-fund balance?
9. Total once-off cost — lease admin, credit checks for two, tags, meter activation?
10. Deposit interest arrangement, and which account is it held in?
11. Generator or inverter for load-shedding, and water tanks for outages?
12. Early-cancellation penalty — can it be capped in writing?
13. **Is it still available?**

PETRA NERA

1. **Are sanitation, sewerage and refuse billed on top of the R1,150, or included?** Decisive — anything above R230 and SoHo wins.
2. If billed separately, what did they come to last month?
3. Can we see a recent utility bill, so the R1,150 is confirmed rather than estimated?
4. **What does the R2,000 admin fee cover, and is it negotiable?** Market rate is R950–R1,500.
5. What is the annual escalation percentage?
6. Security setup — guard, access control, CCTV, perimeter?
7. How many parking bays, covered or allocated?
8. Backup power and water storage during load-shedding and outages?
9. Age and condition of geyser, plumbing and roof — who pays for repairs?
10. Will the landlord contribute to repainting given the condition?
11. Exact walking route to the CRC entrance — is it lit at night?
12. When is it available, and is R9,000 held for a 12-month lease?

MEANDER LIFESTYLE

1. **Does the zero-deposit offer apply to this unit?** And does a fee, insurance product or higher rent replace it?
2. **What notice period applies on the month-to-month lease**, for you and for the landlord? How

often can rent be revised?

3. **Does the R1,365 levy include sanitation, sewerage and refuse** — or are those billed on top?
4. What does a two-person flat here actually spend on electricity a month? Is the geyser electric, gas or solar?
5. Is water metered per unit, and roughly what does it come to?
6. Does the solar backup power the whole unit or only essentials, and for how long?
7. What does the water backup cover during a municipal outage?
8. Is the gym, padel court and clubhouse access genuinely free, or is there a facility fee?
9. Are both carport bays allocated and secure?
10. Do the levies escalate, and by how much?
11. Total once-off cost — admin, credit checks for two, biometric registration?
12. Is the restaurant and coffee shop on the estate, and are the meeting rooms bookable free?

METHOD

How the figures were checked

SOHO WATER – IT IS IN THE LEVY

Sale listings for SoHo Junction units state that **water is included in the levy**, alongside complex maintenance. One 2-bed shows a levy of **R2,207.77** made up of reserve fund R540.74, **sewerage R704.47**, CSOS R32.52, plus water and maintenance — with rates and taxes of R924.64 on top, of which **refuse is R353.05**.

That reconciles the rental listing neatly: the R900 the tenant is charged for “sanitation” tracks the R704 sewerage line, and the R500 “refuse & security” tracks the R353 refuse line plus a security share. **The R50 water line here is a buffer, not a bill** — it may well be R0.

Correction to an earlier note: I previously justified R50 by Johannesburg’s first-6 kL-free allowance. That does not apply per flat in a bulk-metered scheme — the allowance lands once on the body corporate’s account, which then reconciles usage per unit on an inclining block tariff. The R50 still stands, but because water sits in the levy, not because of a free allowance.

SOHO ELECTRICITY – REVISED DOWN TO R650

The developer’s own specification confirms three things that matter: **gas hobs, a central water heating system and low-energy lights**, described as an energy-efficient design. So the flat has no electric geyser and no electric cooking load — between them the two largest items on a normal bill.

A two-person flat runs 300–450 kWh a month. Strip the geyser at 30–40%, the hob at roughly 10%, and LED lighting, and what is left is fridge, washing machine, oven, kettle, electronics and standby — about **150–250 kWh**. At City Power’s 2026/27 prepaid rate of R3.06–R4.37 per kWh that is **R500–R1,000, centring near R650**. The estimate has moved from R700 to R650.

The ~R200 monthly fixed charges — R70 service, R130 network capacity — sit on the scheme’s bulk account in a complex this size, not on your prepaid meter. **Petra Nera’s actual R1,000**, for a larger flat heating its own water, is exactly where this model predicts, which is the best evidence available that the SoHo figure is sound.

UBER FARES

Your two figures — R50 over about 5 km, R95 over about 25 km — fit a fare of roughly **R39 plus R2.25 a kilometre**. That model produces the Meander and gym fares. It is the weakest link in the comparison and the reason Meander lands last, so **price those trips in the app** before relying on it.

INTERNET – NEW THIS ROUND

Meander includes free uncapped internet, which showed that internet had not been costed anywhere. Uncapped home fibre runs **R600–R900 a month** in 2026; R800 is used for the three options that do not include it. This raised every total by R800 but left the gaps between Petra Nera and the SoHo units unchanged.

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	SOURCE / CHANGE IT IF...
Occupancy	Two people, all four flats	Third room at Petra Nera used as a study, not let
Transport mode	Uber for everything	If either of you gets a car, parking matters and Meander's and SoHo A's two bays come into play
Uber — SoHo to CRC	R50 each way	Your figure
Uber — Petra Nera / SoHo to Wits	~R95 each way	Your figure — "just under R100"
Uber — Meander to CRC	~R60 each way	Estimated over ~10 km. Check in the app
Uber — Meander to Wits	~R110 each way	Estimated over ~32 km. Check in the app
Uber — Petra Nera to gym	~R45 each way	Estimated over ~3.5 km. At R60 the two lead options are already level
CRC trips	13 round trips a month	Mon, Tue, Thu × 4.33 weeks
Wits trips	4.3 round trips a month	Wednesdays, no CRC on campus days
Gym visits	3× a week	See the sensitivity table for 2, 3.7, 4, 5 and 6
Internet	R800/month	B, C and A. R0 at Meander — included
SoHo R8,800 levies	R900 + R500	Inferred from the R9,500 listing for the same complex — not quoted. Confirm before signing
SoHo electricity / water	R650 / R50	Gas hobs, central water heating and LED lighting confirmed by the developer. Range R500–R1,000. Water is stated as included in the SoHo levy
SoHo R8,800 floor size	Unknown	Not stated. The R9,500 unit is 62 m²
Petra Nera electricity / water	R1,000 / R150	Your figures
Petra Nera sanitation & refuse	Unknown	Worth up to R1,400 — the biggest remaining risk in the comparison
Petra Nera deposit & admin	R9,000 + R2,000	Your figures
Meander levies	R1,365	Stated on the listing, security included, special levy R0
Meander electricity / water	~R800 / ~R100	Estimated. Not stated. Gas hobs and solar should hold electricity below a fully electric flat
Meander deposit	R0	"Zero deposit apartments available" — confirm for this unit
Planet Fitness	R650/month	Single-club range R400–R900; Fourways is a Megaclub. Vitality, Multiply and Reality discount up to 75%
Weeks per month	4.33	—
Distances	Indicative only	Road-route estimates from the address pins. Fares drive the model, not kilometres

SOURCES

- Property24 — SoHo Junction, Broadacres, R8,800 — rent, deposit, parking, amenities, pet policy, availability
- Property24 — SoHo Junction, Fourways, R9,500 — sanitation, refuse and security levies, 62 m², income requirement, sauna / steam room / business centre
- Property24 — Meander Lifestyle Apartments, Treesbank AH, Midrand — rent, levies, zero deposit, month-to-month, 68 m², amenities, free uncapped internet
- Houss Rentals — Meander Lifestyle Apartments — location off Erling Road, solar and water backup, free facility access
- OCC Property — SoHo Junction developer specification — gas hobs, central water heating system, low-energy lights, inverter-ready; Activity Centre with gym, sauna, steam room and business centre; ~400 units across 10 four-storey buildings
- Property24 sale listings for SoHo Junction, 4 Poplar Avenue — levy of R2,207.77 on a 2-bed (reserve fund R540.74, sewerage R704.47, CSOS R32.52, water and maintenance included) and rates of R924.64 (rates R572.59, refuse R353.05). Other units show levies of R1,168–R2,045
- Property24 — water meters in sectional title schemes and Water Utility Solutions — bulk-metered schemes are billed on an inclining block tariff and reconciled per unit by the body corporate
- Johannesburg Water tariffs and the City of Johannesburg approved 2026/27 tariffs — first 6 kL free, R16.45/kL thereafter

- City Power July 2026 tariffs — R3.34–R4.37/kWh incl. VAT, R70 service charge, R130 network capacity charge
- Planet Fitness Fourways Megaclub — cnr Witkoppen Rd & Nerine Dr
- CRC Johannesburg — cnr Witkoppen & Riverbend Road, Fourways